

2024 第三届“联合国采购杯”全国大学生英语翻译大赛

特等奖挑战赛

请从下列五篇关于联合国采购的文章中，任选其一，将其翻译为中文。要求翻译详实准确、简洁明了、流畅自然。

(一)

The evaluation process is an important part of choosing the best offers when a company or organization needs to buy goods, services, or complete projects. This process starts by looking at all the offers that have been received. First, the organization checks if each offer is valid and follows the basic rules outlined in the official request for offers, known as the solicitation document.

After making sure the offers are valid, the organization looks more closely at how each offer meets the specific requirements and needs. This means checking how well each offer responds to what the organization asked for in the solicitation document. The organization also considers how much each offer will cost and what benefits it will bring. The goal is to find the offer that provides the best overall value, not just the lowest price.

When we talk about “best value for money,” it means that the organization doesn’t just look at the price when making a decision. Instead, they consider other important factors like the quality of the goods or services, how quickly they can be delivered, how sustainable they are, whether they meet the required standards, any potential risks, and the total cost of ownership (TCO), including maintenance and support. These factors help determine the best deal for the organization.

The organization provides clear evaluation criteria and methods in the solicitation document. These criteria help bidders understand what the organization is looking for and how they will be evaluated. For example, the organization might focus more on the quality of the offer rather than just the price, or they might consider both equally important.

When using formal methods to request offers, such as an Invitation to Bid (ITB) or a Request for Proposal (RFP), the organization sets up a special evaluation team to assess the offers. This team follows the organization’s rules and procedures to make sure the evaluation is fair and unbiased. The team uses the evaluation criteria and methods outlined in the solicitation document to guide their assessment. The process must be transparent, meaning it should be open and clear to everyone involved. The procurement officer, who is in charge of the evaluation, writes a detailed evaluation report. This report documents every step of the evaluation process and helps make the final decision about which offer

should be awarded the contract. The evaluation process must be done without favoritism or bias to ensure fairness for all participants.

Setting up the evaluation team is a crucial step. The procurement officer oversees the evaluation and works with a team to review the offers received in response to an ITB or RFP. The evaluation team checks that the offers meet the requirements of the solicitation documents and evaluates them based on the criteria provided. Different organizations may have their own ways of choosing the evaluation team members. The team usually includes at least three members and no more than five. It can include procurement officers, technical experts, and requisitioners, who are the people requesting the goods or services. Technical experts might be staff from within the organization, other organizations, or external consultants hired specifically for this evaluation. If the offers include complex sustainability requirements, the team might also include a subject matter expert to assess these aspects. This diverse team ensures a thorough evaluation that takes into account all important factors of the offers.

(二)

Contracts are important documents that formalize the agreement between a buyer and a seller. They consist of various “clauses”, which are numbered paragraphs known as “terms and conditions.” These terms and conditions establish the rules and responsibilities for both parties involved in the contract, ensuring clarity and mutual understanding.

In a contract, a “term” is a statement that deals with a specific topic. For example, it can outline the price of the goods or services, the delivery schedule, payment terms, inspection processes, or warranty details. Each term is designed to clearly define an aspect of the agreement, so both parties know exactly what is expected of them. By specifying these details, the contract helps prevent misunderstandings and disputes by setting clear expectations.

A “condition” in a contract is a statement that can activate or suspend a term if certain situations occur or specific criteria are met. For example, there might be a condition that allows the price to be adjusted if the quantity ordered changes significantly. This flexibility ensures that the contract can adapt to changing circumstances while protecting the interests of both parties. Conditions provide a way to manage potential changes and ensure that both parties remain satisfied with the agreement.

UN organizations have developed General Conditions (GC) for contracts involving goods, services, and works. These General Conditions

establish a legal framework that is included in every contract to ensure consistency and legal compliance. The General Conditions cover standard terms that apply to most contracts and provide a foundation for the agreement. They are designed to protect both the supplier and the UN organization by outlining basic rights and responsibilities.

Because the General Conditions are standard legal documents used by the organization, they should not be changed without consulting the organization's legal authority. This ensures that any modifications are carefully considered and legally sound. Typically, the General Conditions are either attached as an annex to the contract or incorporated by referencing a relevant UN website where they can be accessed. The specific version of the General Conditions used depends on the type of goods or services being procured.

In addition to the General Conditions, an organization may also include special conditions in a contract. Special conditions address unique requirements or situations that are not covered by the General Conditions. For example, a contract might have special conditions related to the specific delivery method or performance standards that are unique to that particular agreement.

While special conditions can be useful for addressing specific needs, it is important to choose them carefully. Adding unnecessary special conditions can introduce new costs that suppliers must consider when

pricing their goods or services. This could lead to higher overall costs for the UN organization. Therefore, special conditions should only be included when they are essential to the contract and provide clear value to the agreement.

In summary, contracts in the UN system are structured with terms and conditions to ensure clear communication and mutual understanding between the parties involved. General Conditions provide a standard legal framework, while special conditions allow for customization to meet specific needs. By carefully considering both types of conditions, organizations can create contracts that effectively protect their interests and ensure successful procurement outcomes.

(三)

Market research is a key step in buying things for a company. It involves finding the best products and services and figuring out which suppliers can provide them. Essentially, it's about looking for items that fit what the company needs and identifying reliable suppliers who can deliver these items.

One important aspect of market research is learning about current prices. This helps us know how much things should cost. We also look at new technologies to see if there are better products available. Additionally, we determine what makes a supplier good enough to work with, ensuring they meet our standards.

Conducting market research offers several benefits. By inviting the right suppliers to compete, we can get better prices and higher quality products. This competition is good for the company because it leads to better deals. Market research also helps us make informed decisions about whether to make, buy, or lease products, when to buy them, and how to budget for them.

Market research should be done while preparing to buy. Procurement officers can provide advice during this process. It's crucial to ensure that no supplier gets an unfair advantage by receiving information too early. Fair play is important to maintain a level playing field for all suppliers.

Another goal of market research is to encourage diversity among

suppliers. This means including suppliers from different countries and markets to have more options. The amount of effort put into market research depends on what we are buying. For small purchases, simple checks using existing lists and past contracts might be enough. For bigger, more complex purchases, a detailed analysis is necessary to handle higher risks and complexities.

In summary, market research helps us find the best products and suppliers, get fair prices, and make smart buying decisions. It ensures we are well-informed and can achieve the best results for the company.

(四)

When organizations handle offers for buying goods or services, they take steps to ensure everything is done securely and transparently. Normally, offers are managed by someone not directly involved in the purchasing process to avoid any conflicts of interest. For simple price quotes, it's typically the procurement officer who receives them. Offers sent via fax or email must go to a secure fax machine or a dedicated email address set up specifically for receiving bids. These machines are kept in secure, locked rooms to prevent unauthorized access.

UN organizations use official email accounts for bid submissions. These email addresses are shared with potential suppliers in the solicitation (请求) documents. It's crucial to keep these addresses secure to prevent anyone from seeing the bids before the designated opening time. In the case of physical submissions, such as documents sent by mail, offers remain sealed until the formal opening, except for certain types of quick requests.

Opening offers is a formal process that ensures fairness and accuracy. All received offers are carefully opened, read, and recorded at the specified date, time, and location as outlined in the solicitation documents. It is recommended to conduct the opening immediately after the deadline to maintain efficiency and avoid any manipulation of offers or acceptance of late submissions. This process is overseen by an authorized official or

a panel designated for this purpose.

Depending on the type of solicitation used, the opening of offers may be conducted publicly or internally. Price quotes are typically opened internally, while bids are often opened in public sessions to ensure transparency. Proposals usually follow a two-envelope system where the technical proposal is evaluated first, and the financial proposal is opened later, sometimes publicly after the technical evaluation.

After the offers are opened, an official or panel responsible for the process completes a detailed opening report. This report includes essential information such as the names and origins of the suppliers, the dates and times of the offer opening, the prices quoted and their currencies, the validity periods of the offers, and a list of any offers rejected for reasons like lateness or incompleteness. Once the offers are formally opened and recorded, they are handed over to the procurement team for further processing and evaluation.

In essence, the procedures for receiving and opening offers in procurement are designed to uphold fairness, transparency, and adherence to established guidelines. By following these strict protocols, organizations ensure the integrity of the procurement process while providing a level playing field for all potential suppliers.

(五)

In the ever-changing world of UN organizations, things can shift fast. Imagine a boat navigating through unpredictable waters. To ensure they're heading in the right direction and avoiding rocks, they need to keep a constant eye on the map and adjust their course as needed. Similarly, UN organizations must regularly check if their plans to manage risks are actually effective. This monitoring ensures they stay on track to reach their goals among shifting situations.

When UN organizations go shopping (procurement), it's like making a detailed shopping list. They need to know exactly what they're buying, why they're buying it, and how they'll know if it's a good purchase. Additionally, they should make a list of potential problems they might see, like running into unexpected sales or products being out of stock. By listing these risks and thinking about how likely they are and what could happen if they occur, they're better prepared to tackle any challenges that come their way.

Picture a soccer game where you can't control the weather. It might start raining, affecting how the game is played. Similarly, UN organizations face risks they can't control, like sudden changes in laws or regulations. Instead of fretting over things they can't change, they should have a plan in place for how to adapt and keep moving forward despite these challenges.

Imagine you're planning a party, but you only have a limited money. You need to decide which items are important and which you can do without. Similarly, UN organizations need to prioritize which risks are most important to address based on their potential impact. By understanding the costs connected with managing these risks, they can make informed decisions about where to put their resources most effectively.

Think of monitoring risks like checking the fuel gauge in your car during a long road trip. You want to make sure you have enough fuel to reach your destination safely. Similarly, UN organizations need to regularly check if their risk management plans are working as intended. This means setting specific checkpoints along the way to measure progress and make adjustments if needed.

In summary, monitoring risks is like navigating through uncertain waters. By staying vigilant, planning ahead, and adapting to changing circumstances, UN organizations can steer their ship safely towards their goals.